



THE APERTURE METHOD™ · CLASSROOM PROGRAM

# Student Worksheet

Five lenses, one answer, and the arithmetic to back it up

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The question this answers: ***What is actually holding this business back?***

PREPARED FOR

**Grades 8–12**

The Woodlands, Texas

One per student · Edition One · The Aperture Method™

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**A NOTE ON THE BUSINESSES** — Every business in this packet is invented. The streets, parks and shopping centers are real places in The Woodlands, Texas, so the exercise feels like home — but no real business is described, and no real numbers are used.

NAME \_\_\_\_\_

BUSINESS \_\_\_\_\_

## Look at it five ways

Answer every one, even the ones that look fine. Finding out that four things are fine is how you know the fifth one is the problem.

### 1. WHO

*Who actually buys this — and do they come back?*

Fine ☐    Worth a closer look ☐    This is the problem ☐

### 2. MONEY

*What comes in, what goes out, what is left?*

Fine ☐    Worth a closer look ☐    This is the problem ☐

### 3. THE THING

*What are they selling, and how many can they make?*

Fine ☐    Worth a closer look ☐    This is the problem ☐

### 4. WHO DOES THE WORK

*Who is needed — and what happens if that person is gone?*

Fine ☐    Worth a closer look ☐    This is the problem ☐

### 5. WHERE & WHEN

*Where are they, and are they open when people want them?*

Fine ☐    Worth a closer look ☐    This is the problem ☐



**NOW PROVE IT****Do the arithmetic**

An opinion is worth nothing here. A number is worth everything. Work out what this problem is costing them — a day, a week, or a year. Show your work; being wrong with your work shown is fine, being right with nothing behind it is not.

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**Say it in three sentences**

**THE ONE THING HOLDING THEM BACK IS...**

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**I KNOW THIS BECAUSE THE CARD SAYS...**

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**SO THEY SHOULD... AND IT WOULD BE WORTH ABOUT...**

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**One more thing, if you finish early**

What would have to be true for you to be wrong? Write it down. Real analysts do this before anyone else gets the chance to.